

About the State

Resume of the News of the Week from All Parts of Oregon

The importance of the cranberry industry to the Astoria section is recognized this season more than ever before. While the picking of the crop is still a week or two distant, the growers have made preparations on a larger scale than last year. As an illustration of the growth of the industry in just a few years, it is interesting to note that the boxes required by the various associations composing the general cranberry exchange are requiring the whole force of the Ilwaco Mill & Lumber company to turn out.

Hop growers in the Harrisburg vicinity are mourning over the present price of hops, having contracted their crops early for 13½ cents a pound. The hops here are very much lighter this year than last, but are of excellent quality. Most of the hops are of the early variety, very little care has been given to the care of late hops. About 10 days will end the harvest of hops in this section.

Increasing activity in the lumber industry is indicated by the sales of small tracts of timber and sawmill equipment machinery of two mills, which had been stored in Eugene for more than a year, which was sold and will be taken to the forests at once.

It is persistently rumored that the farmers' union at Pendleton is contemplating the establishment of a flour mill there. The report has been current for some time and it is known that investigations as to the propriety of the enterprise have been made. At the farmers' union office, however, it was said that there has been no official consideration of the matter.

While the peach crop of the neighboring fruit district is practically a failure, A. J. Haynes and son-in-law, Claude Davidson, who owns one of the largest bearing orchards of the Underwood district of Skamania county, Washington, at Hood River on business, declare the apple crop will be one of the best. "Our crop, in total tonnage," said Mr. Haynes, "will be somewhat short, but because of clean conditions we will probably pack out more fruit than any former year. Our orchard will yield a total of 6000 boxes."

The long-threatened recall petitions prepared in an attempt to oust the Coos county court have been put in circulation and are being signed in various parts of the county. There had been rumors of the action for the last two months, but no papers appeared, and it was believed the affair had been abandoned. The delay, it was explained, was caused by mistakes in the text of the petitions and failure to make sufficient blanks to serve throughout the county. The county officers whose recall is sought are Judge James Watson and Commissioners George J. Armstrong, of Bandon. The candidates for election are J. O. Stemmler, a democrat, of Myrtle Point, for judge; R. W. Bullard of Bullard Station and John Yeakum of Coquille, commissioners, both republicans.

A meeting of dairymen engaged in supplying Portland with milk is to be called in the very near future, announced Alma D. Katz, chairman of the dairymen's committee Wednesday. "We have secured a large amount of data bearing upon the milk distribution problems of other cities and have considered this material in connection with our own milk supply emergency," said Mr. Katz. "We will soon have the entire subject ready to take up with the dairymen."

Lane county farmers are beating the drought. They are raising corn with stalks 10 to 12 feet in height and well developed ears of grain without rainfall or irrigation. Cultivation has not only saved the crop in a dry year, but has produced a good crop through the retention of moisture in the ground since early spring. Rival exhibits of "dry farming" corn were made in Eugene last week. W. W. Potter, who lives near Creswell, exhibited stalks 12 feet tall and the ears well filled. It was grown on "doble" land. W. J. Lee, farming near Mac's station, between Eugene and Springfield, brought in stalks of corn 10 feet in height with two well-formed ears of corn to the stalk. His crop will average between seven and eight feet in height.

The public service commission now has on its docket 104 cases brought by formal complaint. Of this number 69 are railroad cases, 25 cases relate to public utilities and 10 relate to logging franchises. Probably at no time in the history of the commission has it been confronted with such a great amount of work as at present, and it was stated at the commission's offices today that for a number of weeks the commissioners have been active at a steady round of hearings which have required the use of every night for traveling and each day for listening to arguments.

Because they fear their flocks will be entirely destroyed by coyotes, ranchers in Curry county in the Flores creek district are planning to dispose entirely of their sheep and discontinue the business, although it is now one of the most profitable of stockraising. Coyotes have become troublesome in several localities in Curry county for the last two years and ranchers' losses in some instances have been very heavy. Buyers from other sections, hearing of the situation, have been invading the sheep districts recently and purchasing freely at lower prices than sheep are selling for elsewhere.

H. P. Bars, head of the plant pathology department at the Oregon Agricultural college, has been appointed chief collaborator of the national plant disease survey for Oregon. He is asking for volunteers to assist in gathering and reporting information of plant disease in every part of the state. Farmers having practical knowledge of crop conditions, graduates of O. A. C., and others qualified are urged to enlist in this work, which is essential to the success of the drive under way for the biggest crop in the history of the state in 1918. Blanks and full instructions will be provided for each on application to Professor Bars.

Arrangements were completed on Thursday for the employment of a county agriculturalist for Umatilla county. The county court agreed to appropriate for this work in 1918, and until January 1 the expenses will be met out of government funds. The appointment will be made as soon as a man can be found who is familiar with methods of dry land farming.

LeRoy Childs, acting superintendent of the Hood River branch of the Oregon experiment station, says that apple growers, to prevent injury from worms, must keep up their fight this season against codling moths for several weeks longer than usual. "Figures obtained from our recent observations," says Mr. Childs, "show that slightly more than 20 per cent of the worms are still to emerge and deposit their eggs. Many eggs will be hatching for four weeks, perhaps longer. Many orchards need

another arsenate of lead spray to prevent serious infestation."

Fifty soldiers sent to the Beaver Creek watershed in Union county to fight a fire which was menacing the La Grande water supply performed their task so well that the fire was under control Sunday, according to word received at La Grande. Reports from other Oregon forest fire districts were encouraging.

THE KING'S VALET

By RUTH GRAHAM

The king was dead, and the people would have cried, "Long live the king!" but they did not know which of two claimants would secure the throne. Prince Ludwig, the representative of a legal dynasty, was at the capital, but the Crown Prince Rudolph, who had been banished by his father, was in Paris. Rudolph was the choice of the people, but the Austrian government desired to place Ludwig on the throne.

Rudolph made his preparations to go to claim his crown, and being obliged to pass through Austrian territory, the government desired to intercept him. "Your majesty," said Rudolph's boomer friend, Count Ernest Gerhart, who proposed to accompany his sovereign to his capital, "I suggest that we travel as master and valet. I to be the master, you the valet."

"An admirable plan," said Rudolph. "We will adopt it."

That night the two started, the count disguised as a bourgeois merchant, Rudolph as a German valet. The two carried their parts well, the count enacting a shopkeeper who had made money and was consequently proud, Rudolph playing a servant who had all the spirit beaten out of him by a tyrannical master. Count Ernest being the king's intimate friend and faithful adherent, took pleasure in giving him plenty to do and abusing him soundly at the slightest remoteness. Passing down the Danube by boat, the two attracted the attention of the old Baroness von Vallenstein and her beautiful daughter Bertha.

"Hans," cried Count Ernest, "bring me some hock and soda water, and don't spend the whole day gabbling with the other servants. Be quick!" Hans moved away, and Bertha von Vallenstein, who had looked up from her book, cast an indignant glance at the count for the severity of his tone. When the valet returned with the hock and soda Count Ernest berated him for having been gone so long. Bertha von Vallenstein, indignant at the count's abuse, called Hans to her and said to him:

"Do you wish to leave the service of the man who treats you so harshly? If you do I will engage you at once. My mother and I need a manservant."

"Thank you, fraulein," stammered the astonished king incognito. "He pays me such good wages that—"

"I will pay you double."

The king was in a quandary. Count Ernest, who saw what was going on, ordered him away on another errand and when he was gone said to the young lady:

"Fascinating, fraulein. This servant whom you think I treat so unjustly must be handled with great severity. He has overridden every master he has served till he came to me, and at the slightest evidence of kindness he would turn upon me with violence."

After that Count Ernest, seeing his mistake in attracting attention by his feigned severity, treated his servant less harshly. They pursued their journey, eluding the spies both of Prince Ludwig and the Austrian government, and at last Rudolph found himself safe over the borders of his kingdom. He immediately threw off his incognito and, having been joined by a number of his adherent nobles, moved on toward the capital, everywhere greeted with great joy and affection.

Bertha von Vallenstein and her mother, having taken a direct route while the king was obliged to take a very circuitous one, arrived long before him. She could not put away the image of the valet who had borne so patiently the harshness of his master, and she looked for him every day to appear and enter her service. Her mother laughed at her, assuring her that after what his master had said of him she would run a great risk in engaging him and tried to persuade her daughter to proceed with her on their journey. Then the news came of the arrival of Prince Rudolph at the border, and the baroness and her daughter decided to remain and witness his entry into his capital.

Meanwhile the whole kingdom had gone overjoyingly for the legitimate heir, and preparations were made for his reception. It was a beautiful morning that Rudolph entered his capital mounted on horseback, attended by his nobles, Count Ernest Gerhart riding beside him, and followed by a large military escort. As he passed the hotel where the baroness and her daughter were stopping he looked up at the windows till his eyes caught those of Bertha, when he smiled and bowed, removing his hat with especial deference.

"Mother," gasped Bertha, withdrawing from the window, "what does it mean? Am I dreaming, or am I delirious? The king has the features of the valet Hans."

"Nonsense, my dear! There is a resemblance, and since that valet has turned your head you magnify it."

The king was proclaimed, and to the state ball following the proclamation invitations came to the Von Vallensteins. When Bertha was presented to the king, he was observed to whisper something in her ear, and she passed on with an expression of delight on a face also covered with blushes.

What the king whispered was this: "I am ready to enter your service, but not as your valet."

And so it happened that King Rudolph XII. took a wife not of royal blood, but as he received with her an enormous fortune, most of which was spent on the poor of the kingdom, the match was highly approved by his subjects.

OREGON CITY COURIER

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AMONG our large circle of readers there are a great many who are interested directly or indirectly in fruit growing, dairying and other branches of farming. All of these naturally wish to keep in close touch with agricultural activities throughout the state; and to know about any fight which is being waged for the measures Oregon farmers want and against all sorts of schemes that are detrimental to the people and agricultural interests of this state.

We have, therefore, made a special clubbing arrangement with *THE OREGON FARMER* whereby any farmer or fruit-grower, who is one of our regular subscribers and who is not now a subscriber of *THE OREGON FARMER*, will be entitled to receive *THE OREGON FARMER* in combination with this paper at the same rate as for this paper alone.

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OREGON CITY COURIER

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ACTUAL FARM WORK

To meet the requirements formulated by the federal vocational board created under the Smith-Hughes act, Oregon high schools offering agricultural and industrial courses under its provisions must require students of such courses to devote six months in actual farming and industrial work. Superintendent of Public Instruction Churchill announced Sunday upon his return from Washington, D. C., where, with representatives of all the states, he attended a conference of the board to learn its plan of operation.

Appropriations are made by the act for carrying on agricultural and industrial work in the high schools of the state, provided the states match the appropriations dollar for dollar. Oregon is entitled to \$15,000. Of this sum \$5000 is for agricultural courses, and \$5000 for industrial courses, and \$5000 for the training of teachers. This latter course will be in conjunction with the Oregon Agricultural college. One-fifth of the sum allotted for industrial work is to be used for home economics, and actual work in practice houses will be necessary, said Superintendent Churchill, under the regulations of the board teachers in the courses must also be employed the year round.

Under the law each state participating in the appropriation must appoint a state vocational board, and several months ago Governor Withycombe appointed a board of five, of which Superintendent Churchill is chairman. This board will be called into sessions soon, and will so modify the agricultural and industrial courses now given by the high schools of the state, as to meet the federal requirements. The other members of the board are W. B.

Ayer, Edward Stack, Mrs. George McMath and Mrs. C. H. Castner.

Because the act became effective after the Oregon legislature had adjourned, the federal appropriation for this year will have to be met by subscriptions from the educational institutions of the state, and it is not believed that any difficulty will be experienced in this connection. Idaho and Illinois are similarly situated. Because a question has arisen however, as to whether such a procedure would be legal, Superintendent Churchill made arrangements with Senator C. L. McNary to have the act amended if congress will do so.

SEVERAL MOVES MADE

Local Folk Mix Up Scheme of Habitation by Purchases

Rev. T. B. Ford and his daughters, Sadie Evelyn and Mrs. Harold Swafford, are moving from Portland back to Oregon City, where Dr. Ford was for several years pastor of the Methodist church. They will occupy the Don Meldrum home on Twelfth and Washington streets, and Dr. Ford will direct his work as district superintendent of the Methodist church from this city. The Meldrum home is being vacated by Mr. and Mrs. Charles Hood, who are to occupy their new bungalow across the street.

perintendent of the Methodist church from this city. The Meldrum home is being vacated by Mr. and Mrs. Charles Hood, who are to occupy their new bungalow across the street.

This change brings to mind a series of moves by prominent Oregon City people. C. H. Canfield is leaving the city to take charge of the affairs of Henderson & Co., at Hood River, and his son, Raymond, is moving into the big C. H. Canfield home. Mrs. L. Adams has purchased the Raymond Canfield home and it will be occupied by her brother-in-law, A. C. Howland, and family. Mrs. Lena Charman has purchased the home occupied by the Howland's on the bluff near the elevator, but will go to California in the near future. The home has been rented by Mr. and Mrs. E. C. Brownlee. The Charman home at Ninth and Railroad avenue will be vacated for the time being.

Percy Cupper, secretary of the desert land board, has received word from the department of the interior that the matter of an extension of Washington streets, and Dr. Ford will direct his work as district superintendent of the Methodist church from this city. The Meldrum home is being vacated by Mr. and Mrs. Charles Hood, who are to occupy their new bungalow across the street.

tral Oregon Irrigation company, is now a closed incident. Press reports have indicated that the land under the project, which includes about 74,000 acres, will be thrown open to entry, but the letter from the department of the interior is silent on that point.

Comes from St. Helens to Wed
A marriage license was issued here Friday to Clara Howard, of Appleton, Wash., and Joseph L. Copeland, of St. Helens, Or.

WHY YOU ARE NERVOUS

The nervous system is the alarm system of the human body. In perfect health we hardly realize that we have a network of nerves, but when health is ebbing, when strength is declining, the same nervous system gives the alarm in headache, tiredness, dreamful sleep, irritability and unless corrected, leads straight to a breakdown. To correct nervousness, Scott's Emulsion is exactly what you should take; its rich nutrient gets into the blood and rich blood feeds the tiny nerve-cells while the whole system responds to its refreshing tonic force. It is free from alcohol. Scott & Bowne, Bloomfield, N. J.

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